
Design System

Styling approach

CSS Modules with custom properties on: root (src/styles/tokens.css), no UI library. Every value below is a token; components only use token names.

Logo

Use the Pasta Perfect logo (my own design) consistently across the application. Use the cream version on the green page background and the green version on cream cards. Keep the logo at least 56px tall and never stretch or recolour it. The pixel tomato is reserved for the favicon and empty states.

Colour tokens

Token	Colour	Role
--color-bg	Pakistan Green #16330D	Page background
--color-text	Pakistan Green #16330D	Text on cream cards, panels and inputs
--color-surface	Dutch White #E5DCB7	Cards, panels, inputs
--color-text-on-bg	Dutch White #E5DCB7	Text on the green page
--color-primary	Falu Red #701414	Buttons, links, timer digits, dial band (on cream only)
--color-accent	Poppy #DB3E3E	Graphics only: tomato timer body, nav underline, focus ring, CheckerBand

--color-secondary	Asparagus #7EA366	Small text and lines on green, pixel shadow, Info tag, tomato leaves
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Colour balance: 60% green page, 30% cream cards, 10% accents.

Contrast

Text must use combinations that reach at least 4.5:1. Graphics need 3:1. Poppy is used for graphics only and never as a text colour. Falu Red is used on cream surfaces, Dutch White on the green background, and Asparagus text only on green.

Pair (text on background)	Ratio	Use
Dutch White on Pakistan Green	10.08	Text on the page
Pakistan Green on Dutch White	10.08	Text on cards
Dutch White on Falu Red	8.48	Primary button text, Done window
Falu Red on Dutch White	8.48	Links, errors, timer digits
Asparagus on Pakistan Green	4.84	Small text on the page
Pakistan Green on Asparagus	4.84	Text inside the Info tag
Poppy on Dutch White	3.20	Graphics only (tomato on a cream card)
Poppy on Pakistan Green	3.15	Graphics only (nav underline, focus ring)
Falu Red on Pakistan Green	1.19	Never use
Asparagus on Dutch White	2.08	Never use
Dutch White on Poppy	3.20	Never for small text

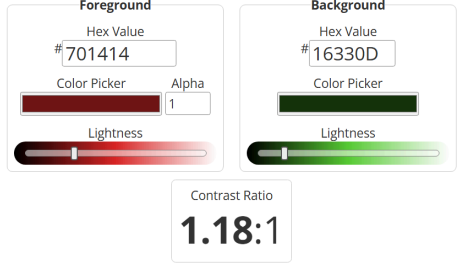
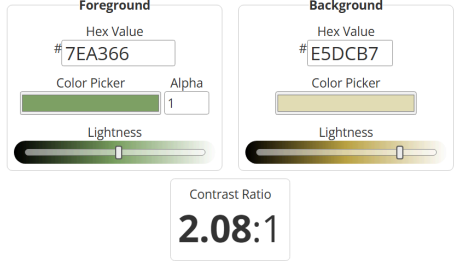
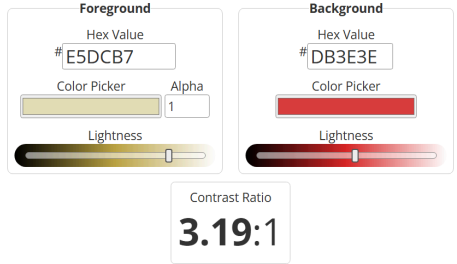
Ratios use the WCAG 2.1 formula.

Colour contrast: verified with WebAIM

Foreground	Background	Ratio	Normal text AA	Verify on WebAIM
Dutch White	Pakistan Green	10.07:1	Pass	Foreground Hex Value #E5DCB7 Color Picker Alpha 1 Lightness Background Hex Value #16330D Color Picker Lightness Contrast Ratio 10.07:1
Pakistan Green	Dutch White	10.07:1	Pass	Foreground Hex Value #16330D Color Picker Alpha 1 Lightness Background Hex Value #E5DCB7 Color Picker Lightness Contrast Ratio 10.07:1
Dutch White	Falu Red	8.47:1	Pass	Foreground Hex Value #E5DCB7 Color Picker Alpha 1 Lightness Background Hex Value #701414 Color Picker Lightness Contrast Ratio 8.47:1
Falu Red	Dutch White	8.47:1	Pass	Foreground Hex Value #701414 Color Picker Alpha 1 Lightness Background Hex Value #E5DCB7 Color Picker Lightness Contrast Ratio 8.47:1

Asparagus	Pakistan Green	4.83:1	Pass (AA only, not AAA)	Foreground Hex Value #7EA366 Color Picker Alpha 1 Lightness Background Hex Value #16330D Color Picker Lightness Contrast Ratio 4.83:1
Pakistan Green	Asparagus	4.83:1	Pass (AA only, not AAA)	Foreground Hex Value #16330D Color Picker Alpha 1 Lightness Background Hex Value #7EA366 Color Picker Lightness Contrast Ratio 4.83:1
Graphics-only pairs (need 3:1, never used for text)				
Foreground	Background	Ratio	Graphics AA	Verify on WebAIM
Poppy	Dutch White	3.19:1	Pass for graphics; fails normal text	Foreground Hex Value #DB3E3E Color Picker Alpha 1 Lightness Background Hex Value #E5DCB7 Color Picker Lightness Contrast Ratio 3.19:1
Poppy	Pakistan Green	3.15:1	Pass for graphics; fails normal text	Foreground Hex Value #DB3E3E Color Picker Alpha 1 Lightness Background Hex Value #16330D Color Picker Lightness Contrast Ratio 3.15:1

Pairs I decided never to use

Foreground	Background	Ratio	Result	Verify on WebAIM
Falu Red	Pakistan Green	1.18:1	Fails everything	
Asparagus	Dutch White	2.08:1	Fails everything	
Dutch White	Poppy	3.19:1	Fails normal text	

Shape and pattern

Cards use a 4px radius, 2px borders, and a hard pixel shadow (4px 4px 0 in Asparagus). No soft blur shadows. Pressed buttons slide 2px into their shadow.

The CheckerBand uses Poppy and Dutch White tiles of 8px, in two rows. (It is drawn at 2x on the design sheet so it is easy to see, but in the app the tiles are 8px.) It sits under the header and above the footer. It is decorative only and uses aria-hidden.

Type scale

Bricolage Grotesque is used for headings and the timer digits. DM Sans is used for body text, labels, buttons, and supporting information.

Token	Size	Weight	Used for
--font-size-xl	32px	800	Screen titles
--font-size-lg	20px	700	Card titles
--font-size-base	16px	400 / 600	Body text, inputs and buttons
--font-size-sm	14px	400	Tags, labels, errors, footer
--timer-width	clamp(240px, 80vw, 420px)	800 digits	Width of the tomato timer

The timer digits are drawn inside the tomato's window, so they scale with the tomato: about 31px on a 375px phone and about 42px at full size. The doneness label in the window stays at about 14px or more.

Spacing rule

Use an 8px base unit throughout the interface.

- --space-1: 8px. Icon-to-label spacing and tag gaps.
- --space-2: 16px. Card padding and phone edge padding.
- --space-3: 24px. Gaps between cards.
- --space-4: 32px. Section spacing and desktop edge padding.
- --space-5: 48px. Page top and bottom spacing.

Visual assets

Pixel-style pasta icons are drawn on a 56px green tile: a bowl (spaghetti, linguine, fettuccine, angel hair), a bow-tie (farfalle), a tube (penne, rigatoni, macaroni) and a shell (fusilli, and ravioli for now). Icons sit beside the pasta name, so they use alt="". The pixel tomato is for the favicon and empty states.

The tomato timer is the main visual element of the Cook screen, modelled on a real kitchen timer. A cream window shows the remaining time and the doneness. A dial band around the middle scrolls past a pointer, so the number under the pointer is the minutes left. The person can drag the tomato left or right to turn the dial and add or take off seconds; moving the pointer up or

down, away from where the drag started, slows it down for single-second control. The arrow keys do the same (1 second, Shift for 10, Page Up and Page Down for 30).

Timer states:

- Idle: 10:00, Al dente
- Running: 06:12, Al dente
- Done: 00:00, Drain now!

At zero, the window turns red, the tomato shakes, and an alarm sounds. People who prefer reduced motion do not get the shaking.

Reusable components

Component	Level	Appears on	Props
Button	Atom	All screens	variant, onClick, disabled, children
Tag	Atom	Presets, Cook, Editor, Recipes	label, tone (recommended, mine, info)
PastaIcon	Atom	Presets, Cook, Editor, Recipes	shape, size
CheckerBand	Atom	Header, Footer	none
FormField	Molecule	Editor, Presets search	label, id, value, onChange, error
SegmentedControl	Molecule	Presets, Cook, Editor	label, options, value, onChange
PresetCard	Molecule	Presets, Editor preview	pasta, seconds, isMine, onStart
RecipeCard	Molecule	Recipes	recipe, expanded, onToggle, onCook?
TimerDisplay	Molecule	Cook	secondsLeft, totalSeconds, status, onAdjust

TimerControls	Molecule	Cook	status, onStart, onPause, onReset, onAdjust
Header / Footer	Organism	Every screen	none

onCook is optional because lasagna has no timer, so its recipe card has no Cook button. Parts that appear on only one screen (FilterBar, PresetGrid, CookTimer, PresetSummary, PresetForm, RecipeList) are on the wireframes.

Tags use three tones: Recommended, My time, and Info. The SegmentedControl is used for doneness (Al dente, Firm, Soft). PresetCard shows the pasta, its time, a tag, and the Start button. Starting a preset opens the Cook screen with the tomato timer.

Screen structure

- **Presets:** shows every pasta with its recommended time for the chosen doneness (or My time if I saved one). The person can search, press Start, or add a pasta that is not on the list.
- **Cook:** shows the tomato timer already set to the recommended time (or My time), the doneness selector, the timer controls, and the buttons Save as my time, Use recommended time, and Edit this pasta.
- **Preset Form:** adds a pasta that is not on the list, or edits and deletes my saved time and notes.
- **Recipes (stretch):** recipe cards that open in place to show ingredients and steps: ravioli, authentic carbonara, cream (Filipino-style) carbonara, lasagna, pesto, Filipino spaghetti, Italian al pomodoro spaghetti, and sopas. Each has a "Cook this pasta" button except lasagna.

The Header contains the logo, the navigation, the "+ Add pasta" button, and a CheckerBand. The Footer contains a CheckerBand. Both are reused on every screen.

Responsive plan

- **Below 640px:** cards become one column, navigation collapses into a menu button, buttons become full width, and the screen uses 16px edge padding.

- **640px and above:** navigation becomes inline, cards sit two to three across using `repeat(auto-fill, minmax(260px, 1fr))`, and the Cook screen splits the timer and details, with 32px edge padding.
- There must be no horizontal scrolling at 375px.

Accessibility checklist

- ☐ Every text-on-background combination reaches at least 4.5:1 (graphics 3:1).
- ☐ Use semantic HTML: `<header>`, `<nav>`, `<main>`, `<footer>` and real `<button>` elements.
- ☐ Decorative images use `alt=""`; meaningful images have alternative text.
- ☐ Every form field has a matching `<label>` (`htmlFor` and `id`).
- ☐ Every interactive element can be reached with the keyboard.
- ☐ The timer dial is a slider (`role="slider"`), so it can be set with the arrow keys as well as by dragging.
- ☐ Focus states use a visible Poppy focus ring (3px, about 3:1 against cream and green).
- ☐ Buttons and inputs are at least 44px tall.
- ☐ Timer completion is shown visually (the red window) and with sound.
- ☐ `aria-live` announces the timer only at each minute and at zero, not every second.
- ☐ Reduced-motion preferences are respected (no shaking, and no tilt while dragging).
- ☐ The decorative CheckerBand uses `aria-hidden`.

Design system rule

The colour, type, spacing and component tokens defined here are reused across all Pasta Perfect screens. Reusable components are built once and used wherever they appear, so Presets, Cook, Preset Form and Recipes stay visually consistent.